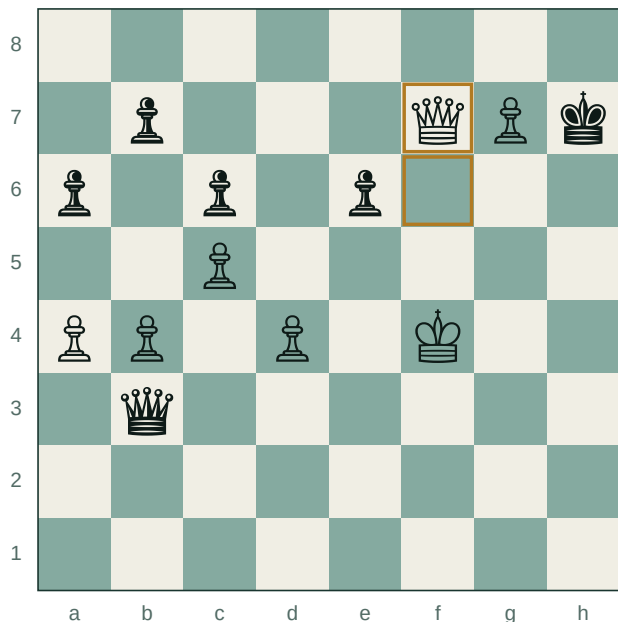


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 59

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 59.Qf7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

59...e5+ 60. Ke4 Qxf7

59...e5+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. The changed line means the queen on b3 attacks the queen on f7. Recorded reply: **60.Ke4**.

60...Qxf7 The queen captures the queen on f7.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -1 to +8. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on f4. Geometrically undefended: queen on f7. Check for tactical protection.